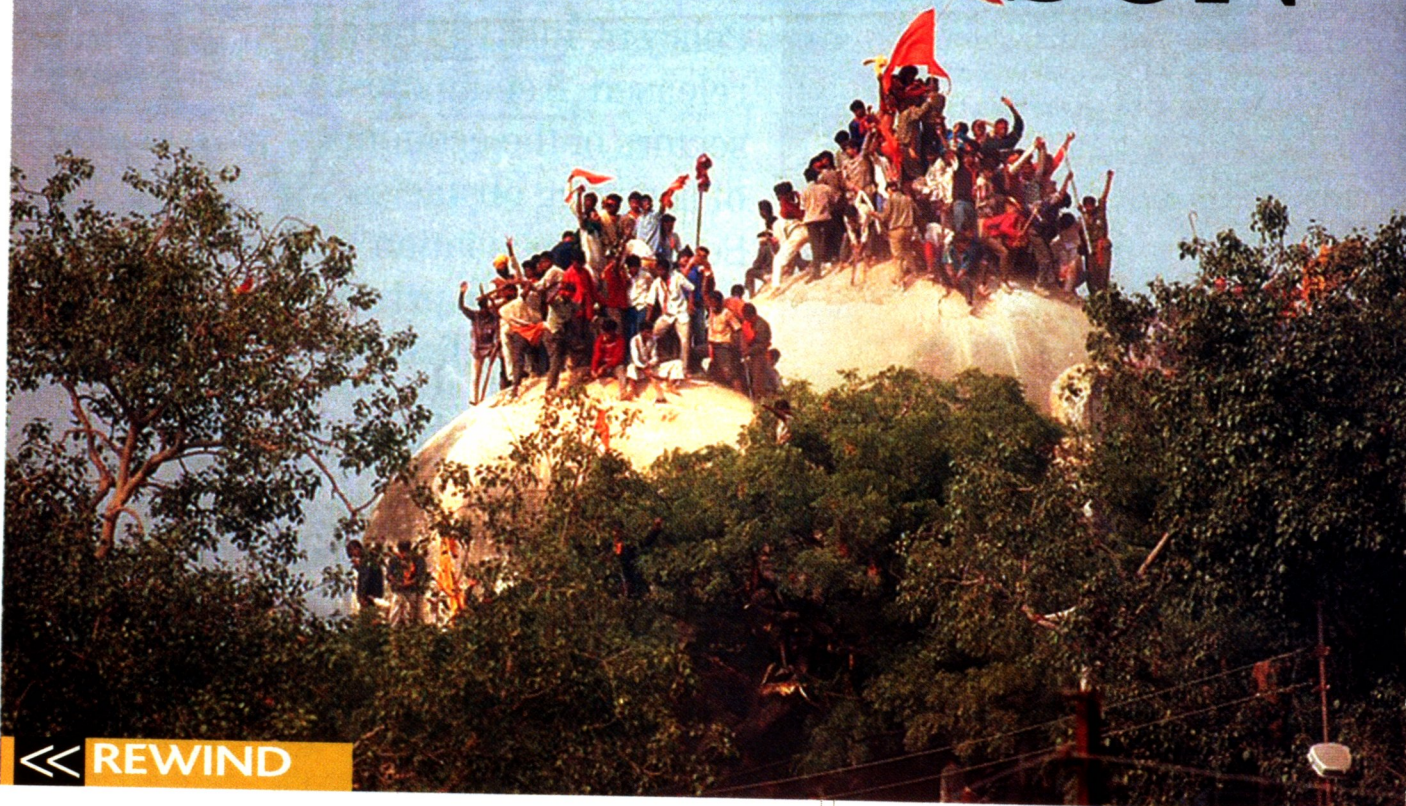




INDIA AT 60

END OF REASON



PRASHANT PANJARI

◀ REWIND

The Ramjanmabhoomi agitation reached its zenith as thousands of kar-sevaks converged on Ayodhya and demolished the Babri Masjid on December 6. In a matter of just five and a half hours, a 400-year-old monument was reduced to a pile of rubble and India's long-heralded secular traditions lay in a shambles. For millions around the country, it was the dawn of the proverbial Ram Rajya. For many others, it was the end of reason and minority rights. The riots that followed left over 700 dead across the country, but the BJP still considered it a living proof of the unstoppable power of the Hindu Rashtra.

PRASHANT PANJARI

◀ WORLD VIEW

The cable TV boom had viewers plugging into the Gulf War, and the World Cup in Australia. By November, 12.82 lakh Indians watched Star TV, which started in December 1991.

FIRST CUT

The Indian Air Force inducted its first women officers, Savneet Shergill and Shivika Khurana. They were both inducted in the non-technical arms.



◀ DID YOU KNOW

The Chief Judicial Magistrate of Bhopal, on February 1, declared former Union Carbide chairman Warren Anderson an absconder in the Bhopal Gas Leak case. He has still not been extradited for trial.